The CONVERGENCE FOUNDATION

Position

Program Associate

About The Convergence Foundation

Ashish Dhawan is one of India's leading philanthropists. He founded and ran one of India's first private equity funds, ChrysCapital, and in the last decade has helped build successful institutions (for e.g., Ashoka University) and strategic foundations (for e.g., Central Square Foundation, which works on school education reform). More recently, these include organisations that are working on building a better understanding between India and East Asia, improving the performance of the public sector, solving the air pollution crisis, and improving the pipeline of leadership and talent in the social sector.

We have set up **The Convergence Foundation** to do this in an institutionalised manner - identify critical voids in the social sector and build strong, long-lasting organisations to solve complex problems.

In order to ensure that our organisations reach their maximum potential, The Convergence Foundation works closely with each of the organisations and to provide strategic and operational support in a variety of ways: developing deep connections with the broader ecosystem (including the government, donors, and others influencers), recruiting best-in-class talent, building a strong brand and network of champions, initiating cross-learning between organisations, building fundraising capacity, and more.

We aim to build a number of new foundations in the next 15 years that will create impact at scale in the sectors they operate in. We are looking for smart, entrepreneurial, and mission driven people to join us on this journey.

Our Current Portfolio

- Ashoka University (est. 2010)
- Central Square Foundation (est. 2012)
- Air Pollution Action Group (est. 2019)
- Asian Century Foundation (est. 2019)
- India Leaders for Social Sector (est. 2017)
- Centre for Effective Governance of Indian States (est. 2019)
- ACT EdTech Ambition Fund (est. 2020)
- Accelerate Indian Philanthropy (est. 2021)
- Foundation for Advancing Science and Technology (est. 2021)
- Circle In (est. 2022)
- Foundation for Economic Development (est. 2022)
- ChangeINKK (est. 2022)
- Sports and Society Accelerator (est.2022)
- The Infravision Foundation (est. 2022)

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Recruitment

While this recruitment drive is being led by The Convergence Foundation, you may be placed at any of the below mentioned portfolio organisations. In case you have a preference for one of these organisations, please make it clear during the application process.

1. **Central Square Foundation:** Focuses on school education reform, with the goal of reducing learning poverty in India to 20% so every child can read and do basic maths. The major priority is improving foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN), with additional work streams in low-income private schools and EdTech.
2. **Centre for Effective Governance of Indian States:** Focuses on improving state capacity in India, by working on outcome measurement (data), personnel management, and strategic budgeting. Karthik is the entrepreneur for this organisation, and is a well-renowned economist who brings a lot of expertise in the space.
3. **Accelerate Indian Philanthropy:** Aims to work with HNIs/UHNIs to unlock capital for the social sector. The core of this organisation is to work with philanthropists to encourage them to give more, give sooner, and give better.
4. **Foundation for Advancing Science and Technology:** Aims to liberalise the S&T policy landscape, and increase the scientific temper of the nation by bringing together academia, institutions, the private sector, and the government.
5. **Circle In:** Circle In aims to drastically improve women's empowerment in India. Women's empowerment is both a moral imperative and a prerequisite for India's social and economic progress.To accelerate women's empowerment in India, Circle In will initially focus on three key areas:
    - Women in the workforce
    - Women's entrepreneurship
    - Sexual harassment at the workplace
6. **ChangeINKK:** is committed to working on causes of inclusion of persons with Specific learning disabilities, gender equality, and the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals. We collaborate with diverse stakeholders including youth, parents, educators, private sector, civil society, and government to *ink sustainable change*
7. **Foundation for Economic Development:** aims to ensure fast, export-led, labour-intensive growth by facilitating high- powered, results-oriented leadership within government and to facilitate ~10% growth per year in India in the next 10 years**.**
8. **Sports and Society Accelerato**r: We are a public-spirited, independent, not-for-profit organisation working to shape the world around us through sport. Our programmes, projects and policy frameworks enable governments, enterprises and individuals to use sport to achieve social goals such as inclusion, equality, sustainability and justice. Our team brings a diverse set of skills and extensive experience in Indian policy, administration, law, and governance to our mission.
9. **The Infravision Foundation:**We are an independent think-tank in shaping and evaluating India's public policy in infra, particularly in the sectors of transportation, energy, water & sanitation, urban planning, rural & agri infra and health infra.

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Position Summary

Our organisations are looking to hire exceptional Program Associates to work with the team on building the organisation's overall research, sharing insights and supporting in development, implementation and evaluation of interventions and projects.

This is a great opportunity for those who enjoy working in a start-up environment, enjoy building and scaling organisations, and care deeply about the impact sector. This role includes working with senior stakeholders and engaging with them on strategic projects that have the potential to solve key development challenges.

Key responsibilities

- Work on strategic projects for the organisation and assist other team members in the design and delivery of projects, in collaboration with external stakeholders.
- Support the leadership team with research, implementation, and organisation-building.
- Aid in the creation of knowledge products across areas including engaging in secondary research, speaking with experts and synthesising data.
- Take on diverse operational tasks to ensure organisational success.
- Assist the leadership team with creating and maintaining deep engagement with top leaders, funders and experts.
- Develop activities and programs as needed, so as to build coalitions and collaborations with the intention to build a high-performing and execution focused organisation in the development sector.

Required Qualifications, Skills and Abilities

- Undergraduate degree from a top tier institution; while there is no preference for a particular major or specialisation, we expect to see a high degree of intellectual curiosity and sophistication.
- 0-2 years of work experience in a challenging/ high growth environment.
- Excellent analytical, critical thinking and problem-solving skills.
- Solid planning and organisational skills with high attention to detail, accuracy, protocol and deadline.
- Excellent writing ability that is clear, concise and analytic in style.
- Excellent communication, interpersonal, and stakeholder-facing skills including solid presentation and facilitation skills.
- High level of flexibility and responsiveness with the ability to shift priorities quickly and as organisational demands require.

Desired Qualities

- High level of discretion in maintaining confidentiality of sensitive materials and issues.
- Ability to take initiative and develop solutions quickly and effectively.
- Ability to understand and consider organisational culture and change.
- Ability to function and interact in a professional level capacity to sustain the mission, culture and best interests of the respective organisations.
- Ability to adapt and exhibit confidence in a highly evolving, agile, and fast paced work environment.

- Ability to do research and distil important concepts in a structured, concise, yet comprehensive manner.
- Broad and strategic mindset, creative aptitude and effective use of independent judgement.
- Operating style suited to working in a small-organisation setting, where teamwork and resourcefulness are highly valued.

Compensation

Remuneration will be competitive with Indian philanthropy pay scales and will depend upon the candidate's experience.

Location

New Delhi, India or others depending on the organisation